

The State of Revenue-Generating Startups

1,000 startup snapshot · what the numbers reveal about scale, monetization & acquisition

Three signals cut through the noise.

THE MARKET IS CONCENTRATED

50%

of all 30-day revenue sits in the top 10 startups.

B2B MONETIZES HARDER

70%

of known-audience revenue comes from B2B startups.

ATTENTION IS WEAK

p 0.17

followers vs revenue; domain rating is materially stronger.

The implication

Scale is not the default outcome. Monetization architecture—not visibility—appears to separate the leaders from the long tail.

The dataset is broad enough to spot patterns—but incomplete enough to demand caution.

STARTUPS

1,000

frozen snapshot

30-DAY REVENUE

\$15.6M

across the sample

POSITIVE REVENUE

78%

of startups

MISSINGNESS

material

especially traffic & acquisition fields

Category

27%

Country

24%

Audience

29%

Visitors

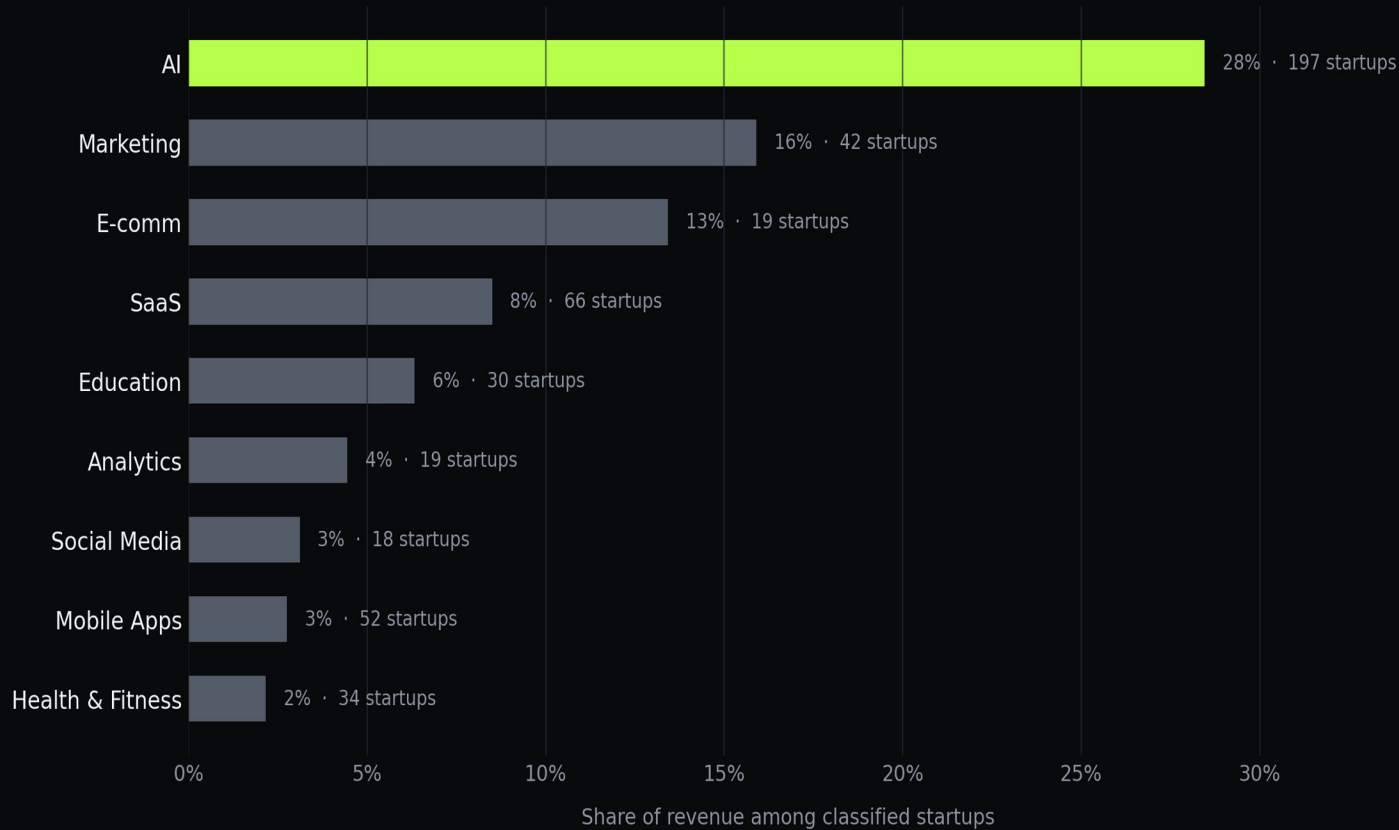
82%

Asking price

74%

Read every percentage with its denominator: category, country and audience are not complete fields.

AI is the largest tribe. But it is not the richest one per startup.



AI

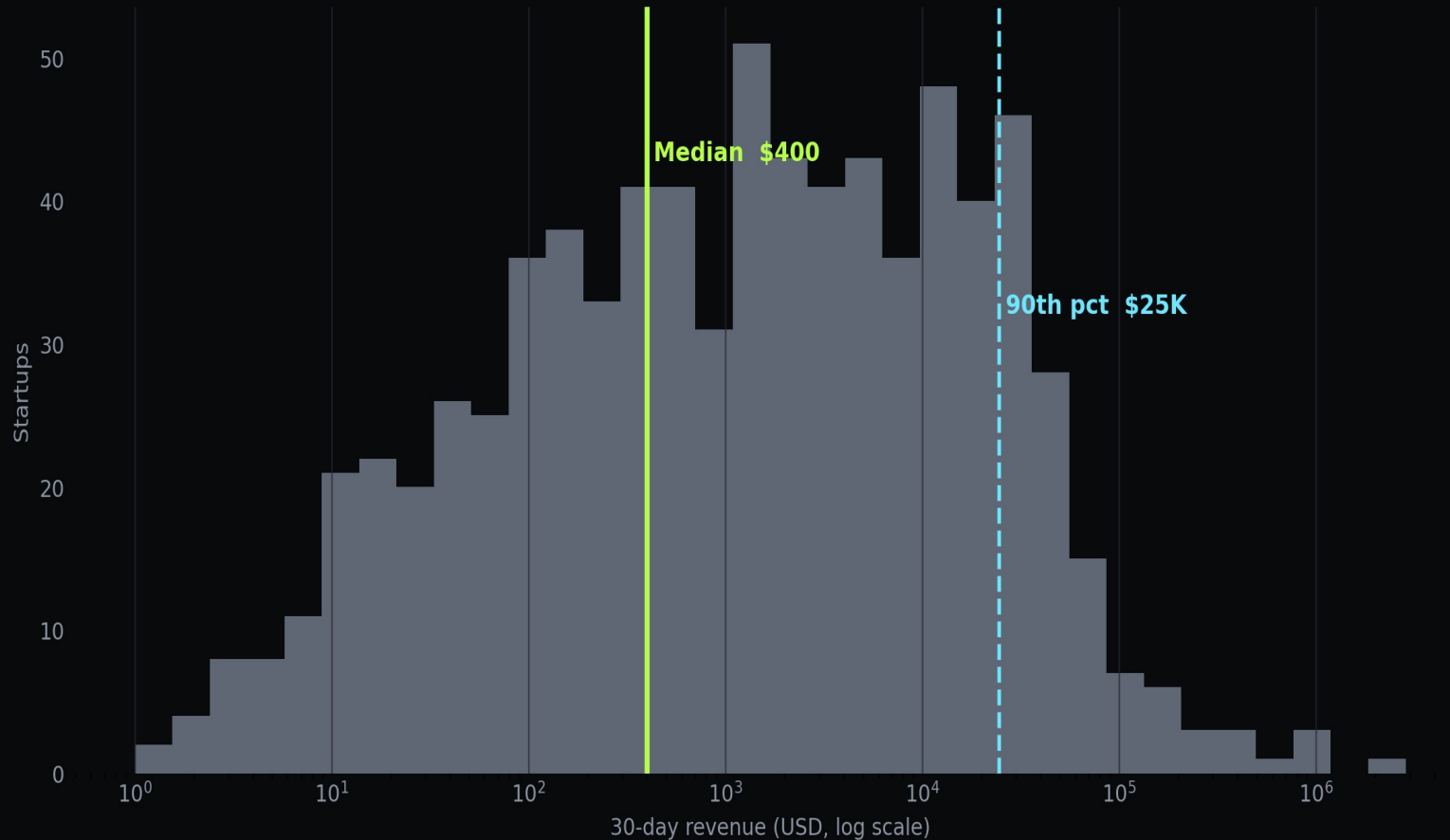
197 startups

28% of classified revenue

The signal

AI has scale of presence, but categories like Marketing and E-comm over-index on revenue relative to their footprint.

The median startup is tiny—and a handful of giants define the market.



MEDIAN 30-DAY REVENUE

\$400

half the sample is below this

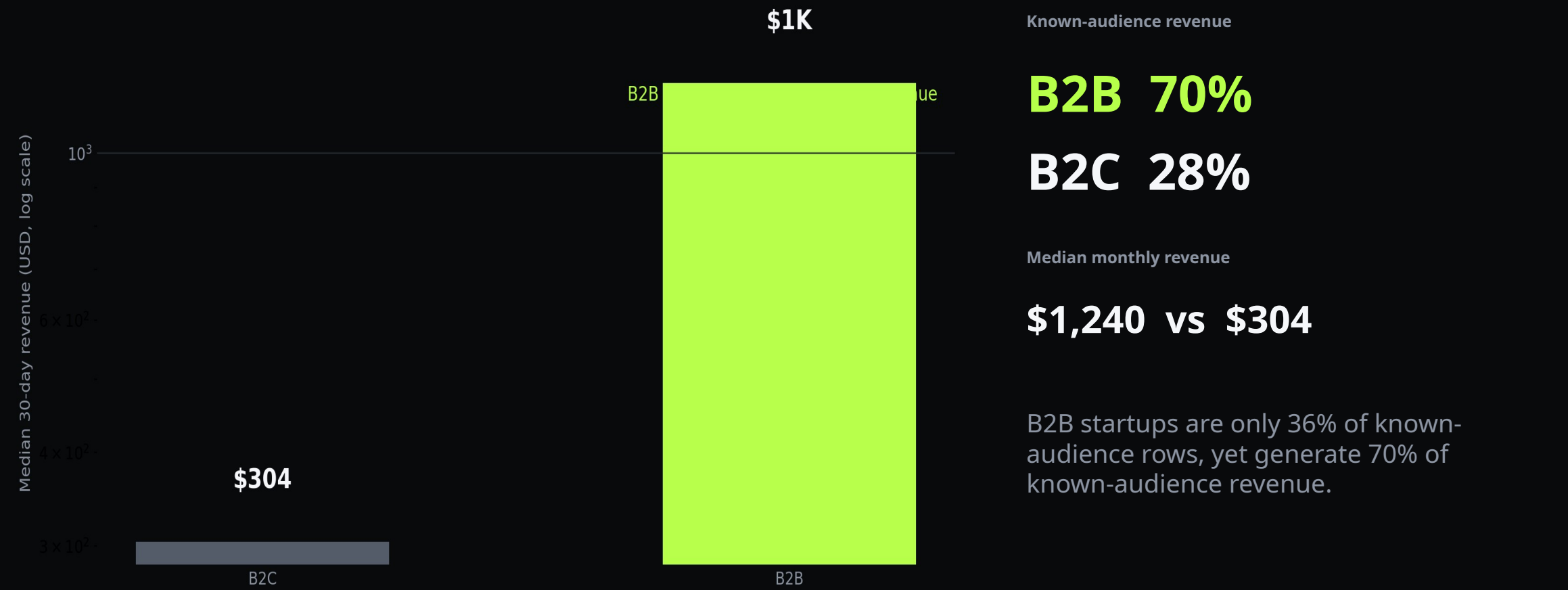
TOP 10 CONCENTRATION

50%

of all sample revenue

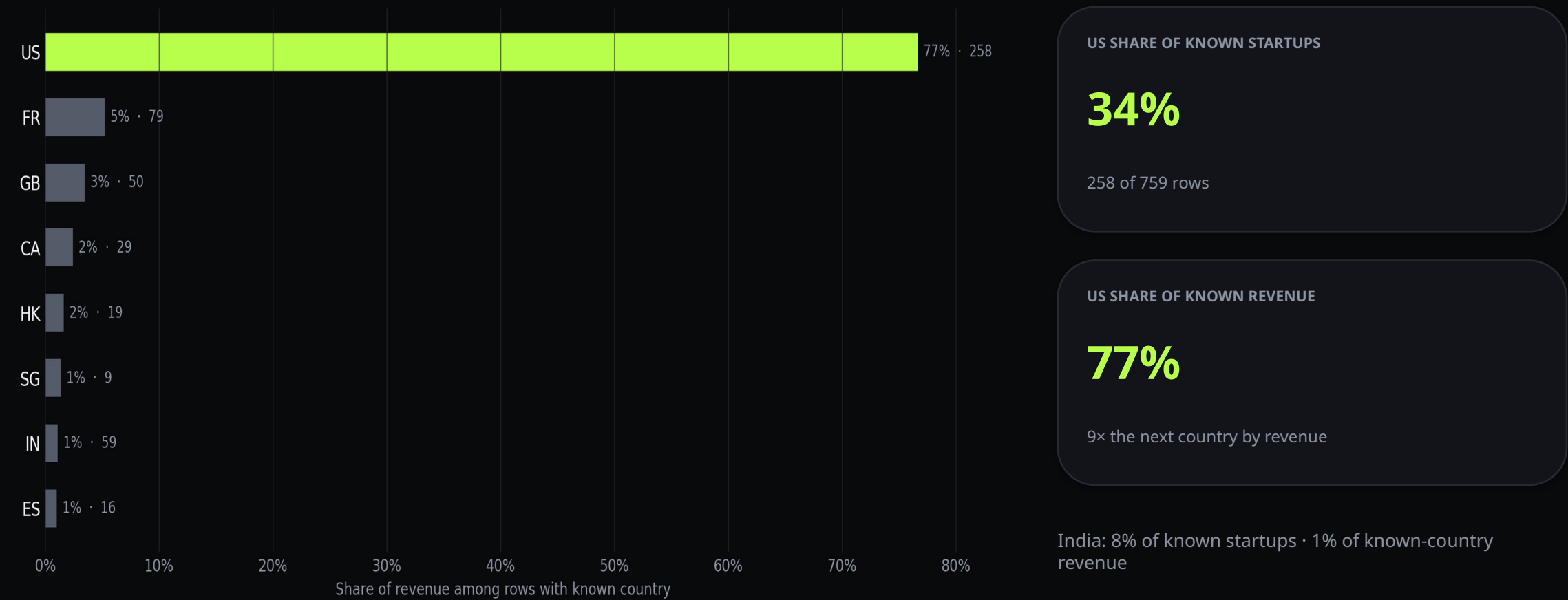
22% of startups report \$0 in 30-day revenue.

B2B is the monetization engine hiding inside the dataset.



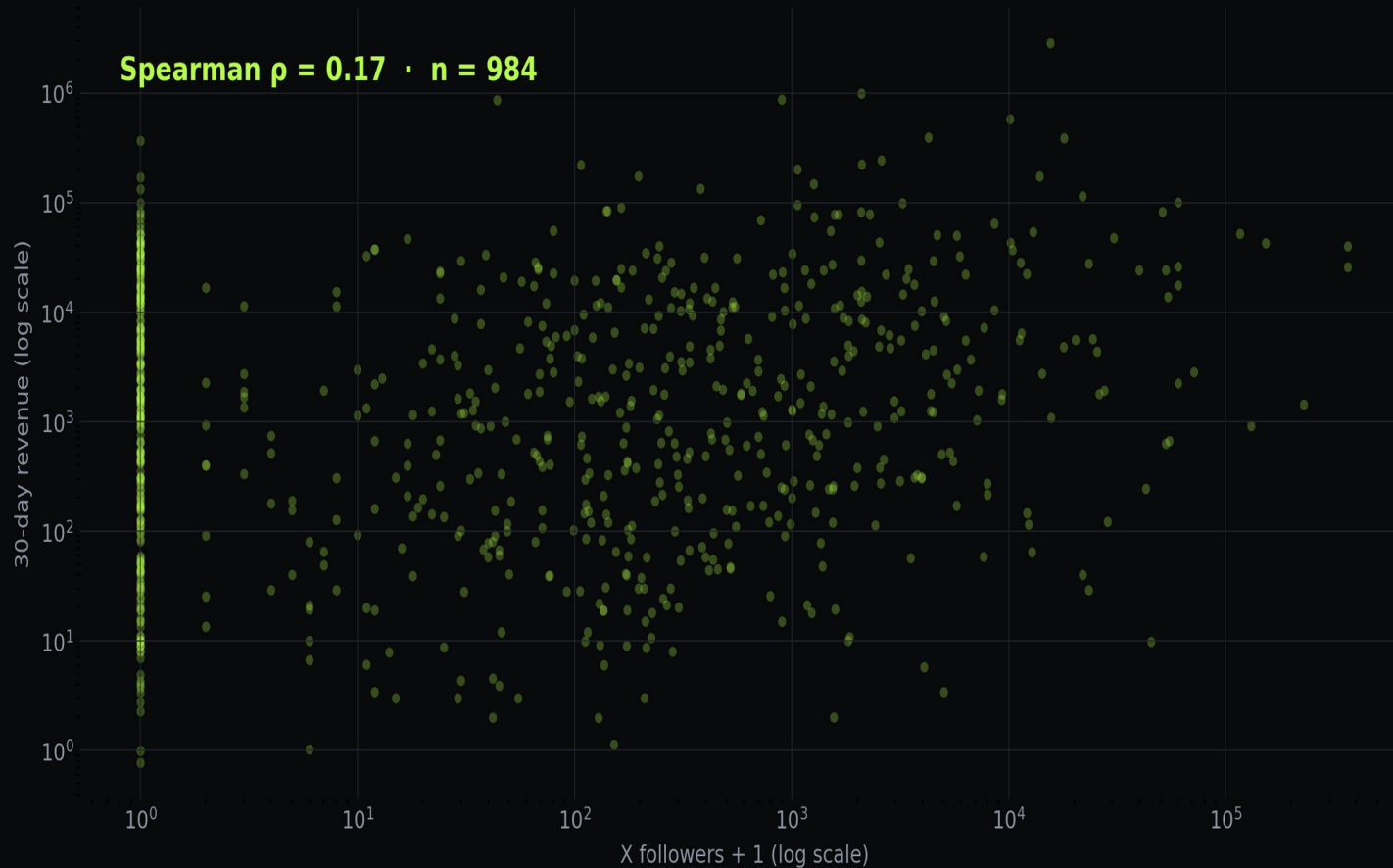
Source: TrustMRR · audience analysis excludes 288 rows with missing audience type.

The US does not just lead the count—it captures the dollars.



Source: TrustMRR · country analysis excludes 241 rows with missing country.

Attention is not the moat.



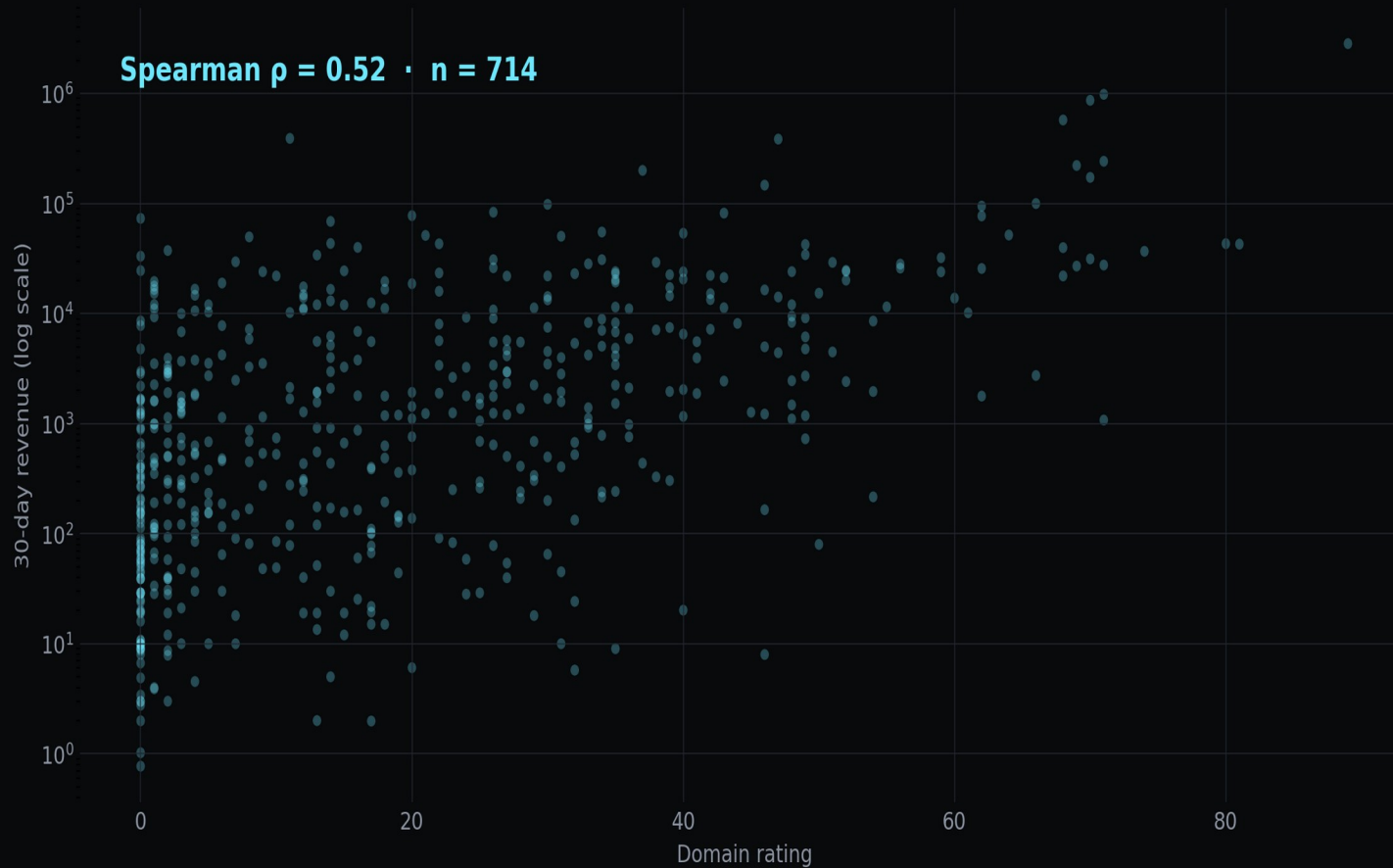
$$\rho = 0.17$$

followers ↔ revenue

A weak relationship.

Some high-revenue companies have modest social audiences. The dataset does not support using follower count as a reliable proxy for commercial traction.

If attention is weak, what looks stronger? Domain strength.



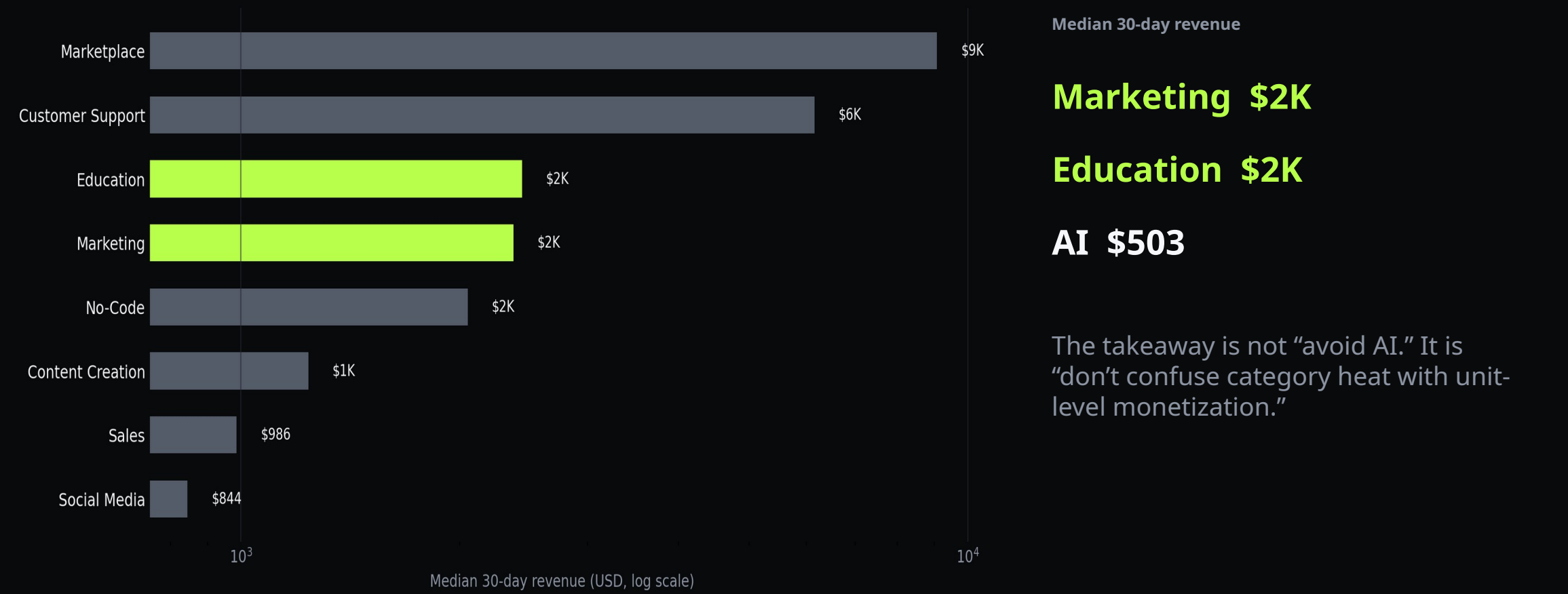
$$\rho = 0.52$$

domain rating ↔ revenue

A materially stronger association.

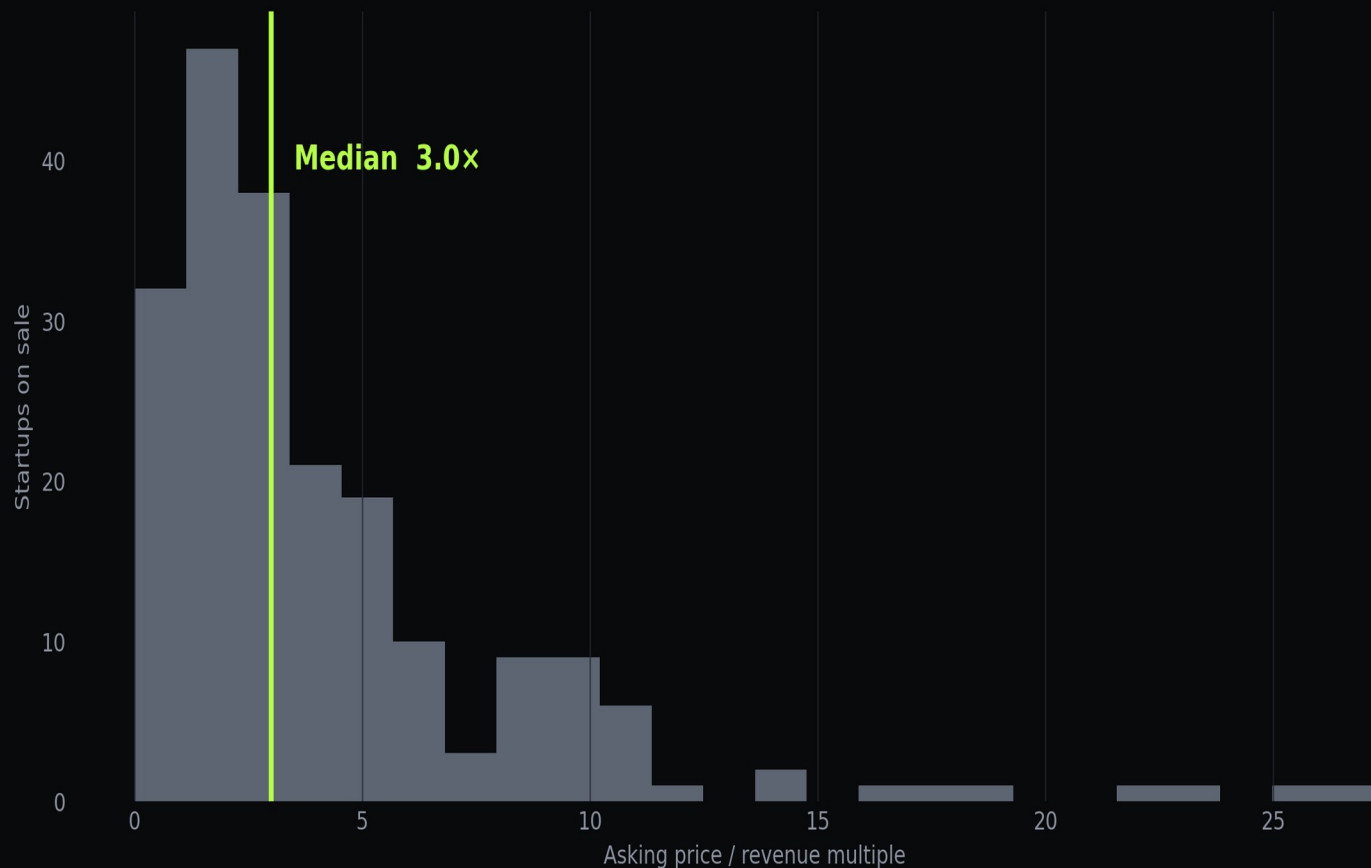
This is still correlation—not causation—but it suggests durable acquisition channels may matter more than visible social reach.

AI gets the headlines. Marketing and Education get the monetization.



Source: TrustMRR · medians use classified rows only.

The acquisition market clusters around a surprisingly modest 3× revenue.



MEDIAN ASKING PRICE

\$60K

among positive-multiple listings

MEDIAN REVENUE MULTIPLE

3.0×

215 listings with >0 multiple

262 startups are marked on sale; 47 show a 0× multiple, so valuation analysis excludes those.

The data points to a different playbook.

FOUNDERS

Sell to a high-value customer before chasing reach.

Build durable acquisition channels, not follower counts.

Design pricing around revenue density.

INVESTORS

Underwrite concentration risk explicitly.

Look for B2B economics inside crowded categories.

Use domain strength as a traction signal—not proof.

OPERATORS

Instrument subscribers, MRR and retention.

Separate acquisition from attention metrics.

Treat small revenue wins as a funnel, not a verdict.

THE REAL MOAT IS MONETIZATION.

The ecosystem looks noisy at 1,000 rows.
It looks much simpler when you follow the money.

Concentrated revenue · B2B economics · durable acquisition · disciplined pricing